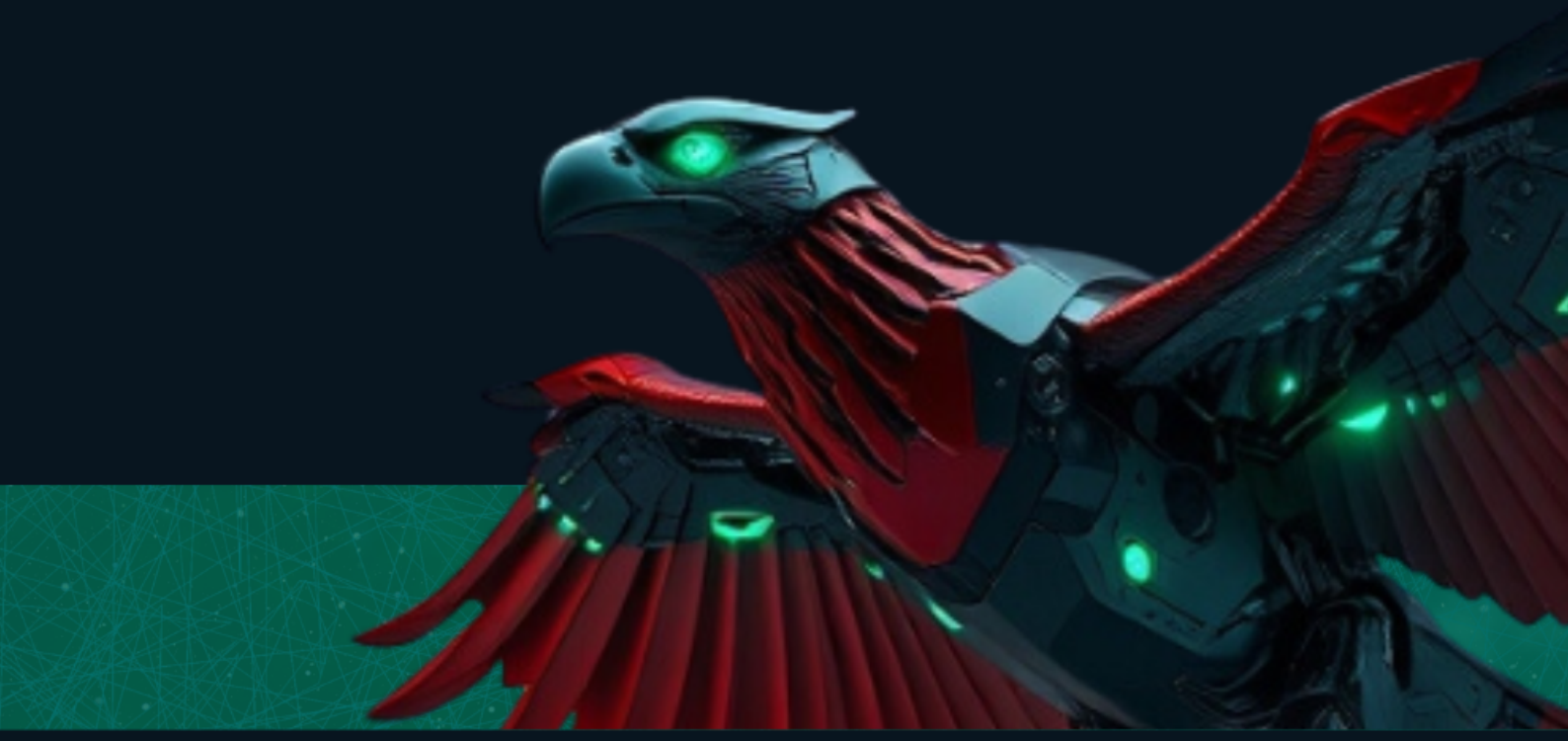
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INTEL REPORT



Report Details

Title	CVE-2026-41096
Sub Title	Windows DNS Client Remote Code Execution Vulnerability
Status	Closed
Type	Advisory
Severity	—
Source	SOCByte
Created At	May 18, 2026, 08:49 PM

CVE-2026-41096

Windows DNS Client Remote Code Execution Vulnerability

Type: ADVISORY • Source: SOCByte • Created At: May 18, 2026, 08:49 PM

Analysis Summary

CVE-2026-41096 is a critical Remote Code Execution (RCE) vulnerability impacting the Windows DNS Client across a wide range of platforms, including Windows 11 (versions 23H2 through 26H1) and Windows Server 2025. It occurs when the DNS Client incorrectly processes a specially crafted DNS response. An attack requires no prior privileges or user interaction, meaning the vulnerable system can be compromised solely at the will of the attacker, provided they can successfully inject or spoof a malicious DNS response to a target system. If successfully exploited, an unauthenticated attacker could remotely execute arbitrary code on the affected system with elevated privileges, potentially leading to a complete compromise of confidentiality, integrity, and availability. Microsoft addressed this vulnerability in its May 12, 2026, Patch Tuesday rollout. Official fixes are available for all vulnerable architectures (including x64 and ARM64). Immediate deployment of these security updates is highly recommended to eliminate the attack vector.

Affected Product

- Windows 11 version 22H3 affected from 10.0.22631.0 before 10.0.22631.7079
- Windows 11 Version 23H2 affected from 10.0.22631.0 before 10.0.22631.7079
- Windows 11 Version 24H2 affected from 10.0.26100.0 before 10.0.26100.8457
- Windows 11 Version 25H2 affected from 10.0.26200.0 before 10.0.26200.8457
- Windows 11 version 26H1 affected from 10.0.28000.0 before 10.0.28000.2113
- Windows Server 2022
- 23H2 Edition (Server Core installation) affected from 10.0.25398.0 before 10.0.25398.2330
- Windows Server 2025 affected from 10.0.26100.0 before 10.0.26100.32860
- Windows Server 2025 (Server Core installation) affected from 10.0.26100.0 before 10.0.26100.32860

Impact

- Exploit Public-Facing Application — T1190
- Remote Services — T1021
- Command and Scripting Interpreter — T1059
- Exploitation for Privilege Escalation — T1068
- Impair Defenses — T1562

Vulnerabilities (CVEs)

CVE Number	Description	Published	CVSS Score
CVE-2026-41096	Heap-based buffer overflow in Microsoft Windows DNS allows an unauthorized attacker to execute code over a network.	5/11/2026	9.8

Remediation

- Roll out Microsoft’s May 2026 security updates (or later cumulative) to all supported Windows clients and servers that use the DNS Client. Make sure machines actually reboot after installing; until the reboot, they’re still effectively vulnerable.
- Lock DNS to trusted resolvers: use only your approved internal or trusted external DNS resolvers and block direct outbound DNS so clients cannot talk to arbitrary public resolvers.
- Require VPN for remote users, review Wi Fi and router configs to ensure they are not handing out untrusted DNS servers via DHCP.
- Watch for unusual DNS patterns: large or malformed responses, spikes in DNS errors, or DNS client crashes on Windows hosts.
- Document this CVE in your internal risk register and change records.